

THE BIG STORY

BJP

STATES OF ANXIETY

THE BJP MAY HAVE A NEW PRESIDENT IN PLACE, BUT IT HAS WORK LEFT TO DO IN FOUR CRUCIAL STATES—KARNATAKA, HARYANA, PUNJAB AND DELHI

By **ANILESH S. MAHAJAN**

THROUGH THE WINTER OF 2025, all the news coming out from the Bharatiya Janata Party organisation was about the long-delayed election of a new party president. That season ended in the last week of December, when the BJP brass announced Bihar minister and five-time MLA Nitin Nabin would replace J.P. Nadda. According to party bylaws, the election for national president requires a 50 per cent quorum from the 36 state units (including UTs). The party had the quorum: 31 state units had been elected already. The problem, which continues till date, has been the five remaining states.

State presidents are yet to be elected formally in Karnataka, Haryana, Punjab and Delhi, four politically crucial zones where the BJP has tough choices to make. The fifth state in the list is Manipur in the Northeast, where the situation is still too fraught to consider even a discussion